HACK THE GRID

BrightBoard

Challenge 01 — Reflected XSS

XSS · Easy · Web · JavaScript

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QUESTION 01

RECONNAISSANCE

Start the lab and identify the platform

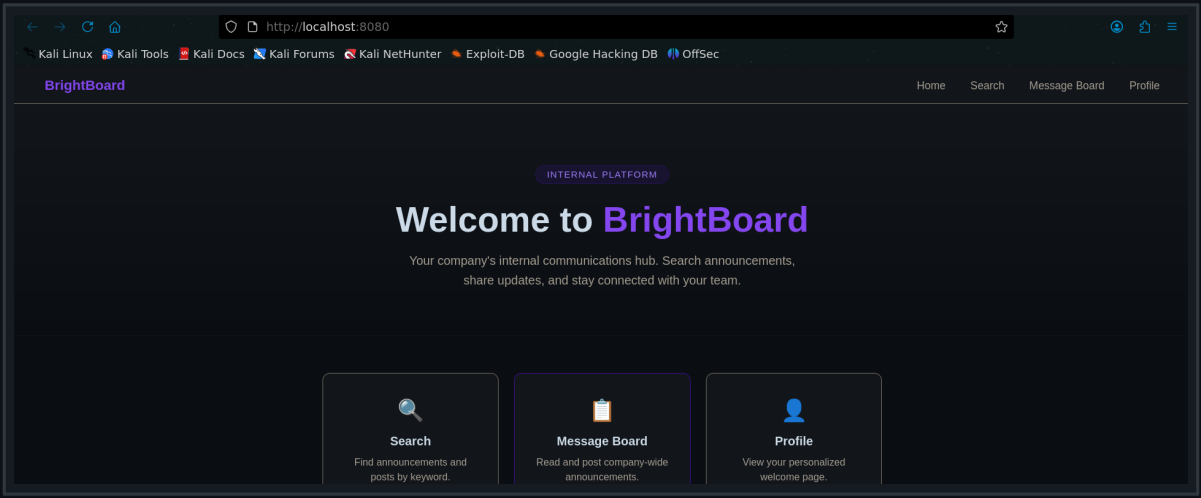
QUESTION

Extract the lab zip using the password infected and start it by running bash start.sh inside the extracted folder. Open your browser and go to http://localhost:8080. What is the name of the internal platform shown in the top-left of the navigation bar?

HOW TO SOLVE

1. Extract the zip file using the password infected.
2. Navigate into the extracted folder and run bash start.sh to start the lab.
3. Open your browser and go to http://localhost:8080.
4. Look at the top-left of the navigation bar and read the platform name.

SCREENSHOTS



ANSWER **BrightBoard**

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QUESTION 02

RECONNAISSANCE

Navigate to Search — find the URL parameter

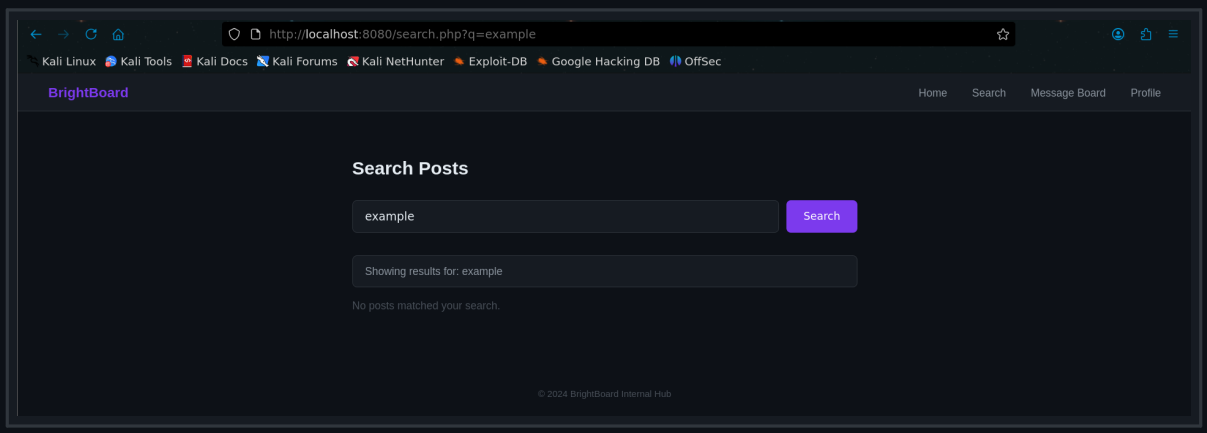
QUESTION

Click Search in the navigation bar and type any word in the search box, then click Search. Look at the URL bar after the page loads. What is the name of the URL parameter that carries your search term?

HOW TO SOLVE

1. Click Search in the navigation bar at the top of the page.
2. Type any word into the search box and click Search.
3. Look at the URL bar — it changes to include your search term.
4. The URL parameter is the name that appears between the ? and the = sign.

SCREENSHOTS



ANSWER q

QUESTION 03

SOURCE ANALYSIS

View Page Source — find where input is reflected

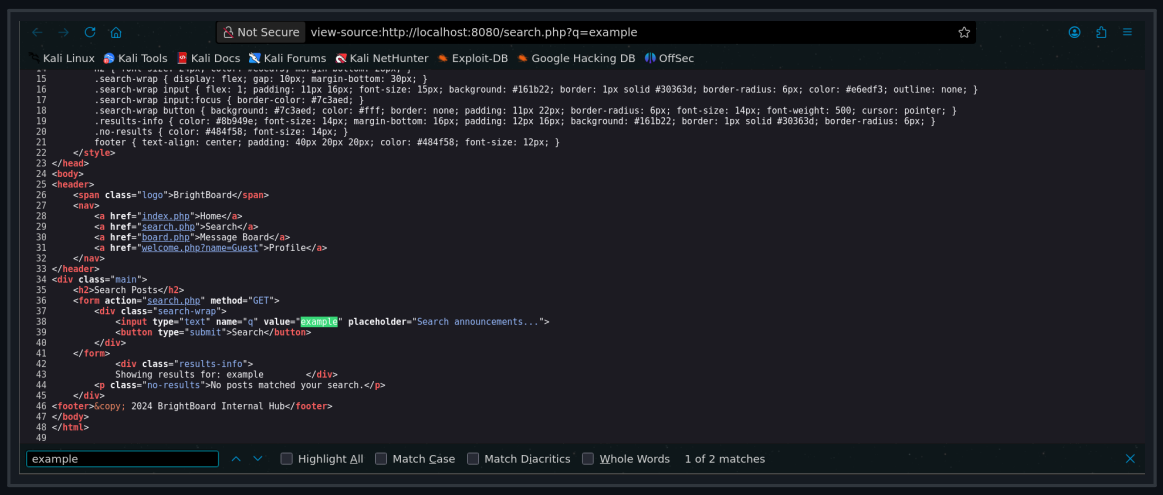
QUESTION

Right-click anywhere on the Search page and select View Page Source. Press Ctrl+F and search for your query in the source. Your input appears inside the value attribute of the search box element. What is the HTML tag name of that element?

HOW TO SOLVE

1. Right-click anywhere on the Search page and select View Page Source.
2. Press Ctrl+F to open the search bar in the source viewer.
3. Type your search term to jump to where it appears in the source.
4. Look at the HTML tag that contains a value attribute holding your input.
5. Read the tag name — it is the word that appears right after the opening < symbol.

SCREENSHOTS



ANSWER `input`

QUESTION 04

EXPLOITATION

HTML injection — confirm unescaped output

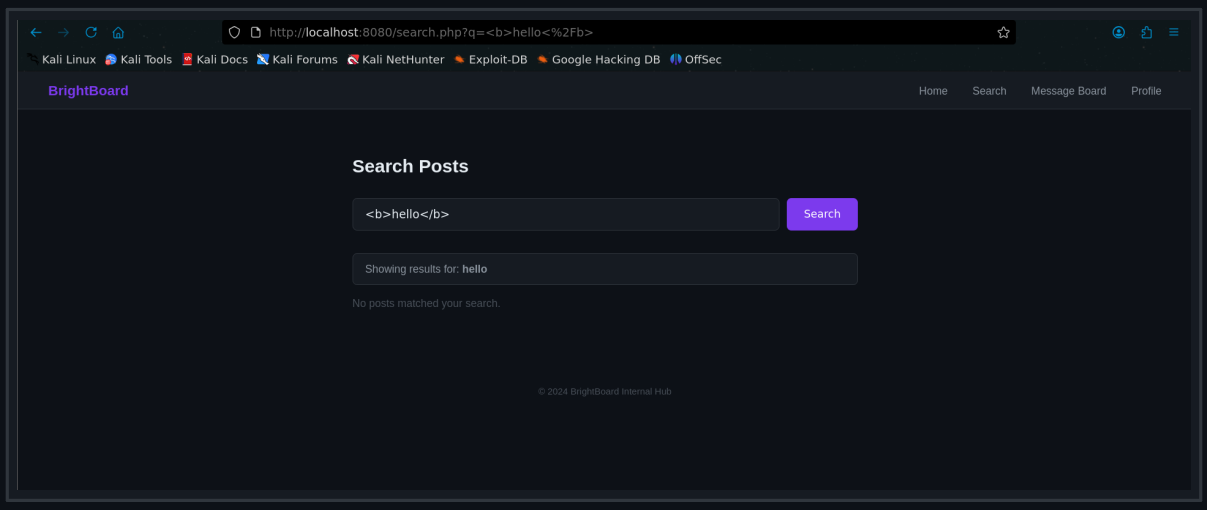
QUESTION

Type `<b>hello</b>` in the search box and click Search. Look at the Showing results for: line on the page. What word is rendered in bold?

HOW TO SOLVE

1. In the search box, type exactly: hello
2. Click Search.
3. Look at the 'Showing results for:' line below the search box.
4. If the server escapes your input, you would see the literal text hello.
5. If the word appears in bold, the server is echoing raw HTML — which confirms the vulnerability.

SCREENSHOTS



ANSWER `hello`

QUESTION 05

EXPLOITATION

Script injection — trigger JavaScript execution

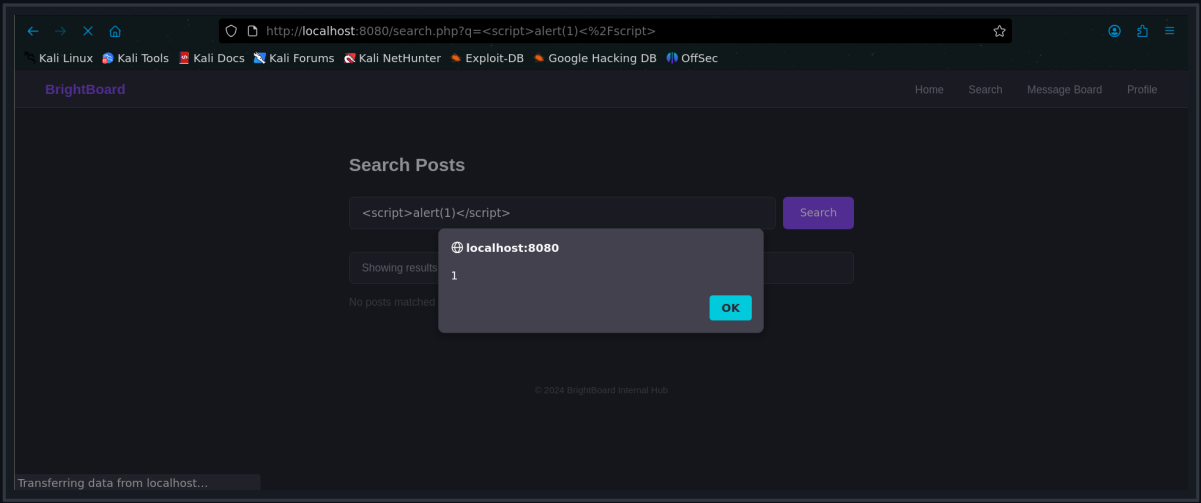
QUESTION

Type `<script>alert(1)</script>` in the search box and click Search. A popup appears in the browser window. What number is displayed inside the alert?

HOW TO SOLVE

1. In the search box, type exactly: <script>alert(1)</script>
2. Click Search.
3. A browser alert popup appears — the server echoed your script tag directly into the page and the browser executed it.
4. Read the number shown inside the popup.

SCREENSHOTS



ANSWER 1

QUESTION 06

EXPLOITATION

Identify the attack parameter in the URL

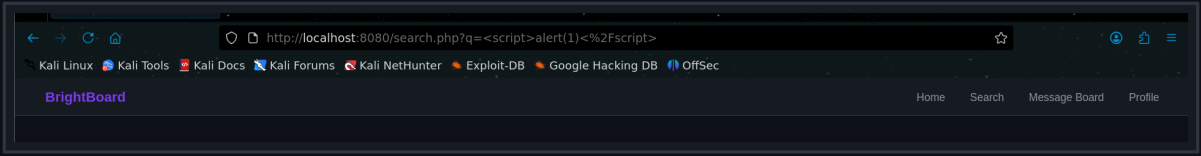
QUESTION

After triggering the alert from Q5, close the popup and look at the URL bar. The entire payload is visible in the address. What is the name of the URL parameter that carries the malicious script?

HOW TO SOLVE

1. Close the alert popup by clicking OK.
2. Look at the URL bar — your full <script> payload is visible in the address.
3. Identify the parameter name — it appears between the ? and the = sign, just like in Q2.

SCREENSHOTS



ANSWER q

QUESTION 07

EXPLOITATION

Name the type of XSS

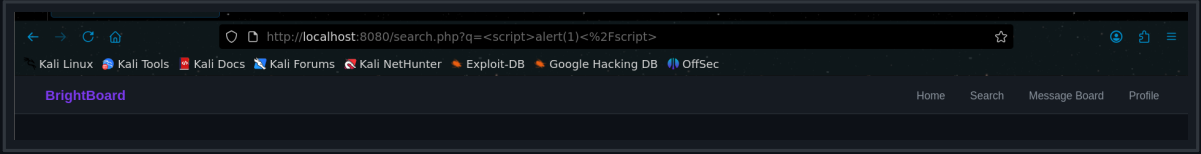
QUESTION

The payload traveled through the URL, the server read it from the query string and echoed it straight back into the HTML — it was never saved to a database. Because it only executes when someone visits that specific crafted URL, this is a specific type of XSS. What is it called?

HOW TO SOLVE

1. Think about what you observed in Q5 and Q6.
2. The script was in the URL, the server reflected it back in the response.
3. It is not stored anywhere — it only fires when the exact URL is visited.
4. This is one of three main types of XSS — name the one that matches this behaviour.

SCREENSHOTS



ANSWER **Reflected XSS**

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QUESTION 08

EXPLOITATION

Read the page domain via JavaScript

QUESTION

Type `<script>alert(document.domain)</script>` in the search box and click Search. What value appears in the alert?

HOW TO SOLVE

1. In the search box, type exactly: <script>alert(document.domain)</script>
2. Click Search.
3. The script runs and reads the domain of the current page from the browser.
4. Read the value shown in the alert popup.

ANSWER `localhost`

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QUESTION 09

EXPLOITATION

Write your own payload — alert a custom word

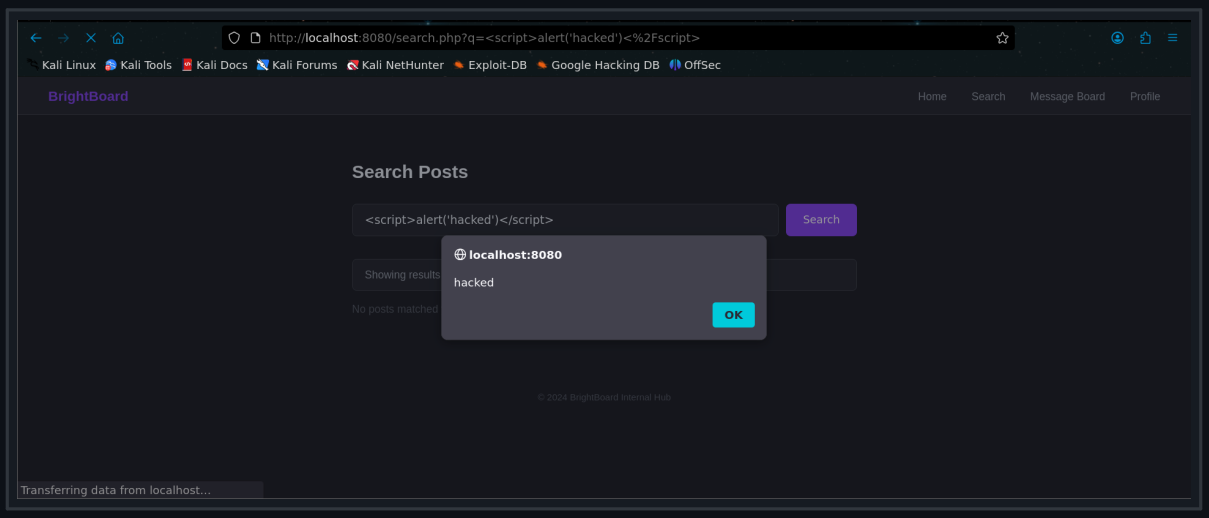
QUESTION

Based on what you learned in Q5, write the payload you would type in the search box to make an alert pop up displaying the word `hacked`. Type it in and confirm it works.

HOW TO SOLVE

1. Think about the structure of the payload from Q5: <script>alert(1)</script>
2. To display text instead of a number, you need to wrap it in quotes inside the alert.
3. Type your payload in the search box and click Search.
4. The alert should display the word hacked.

SCREENSHOTS



ANSWER `<script>alert('hacked')</script>`

QUESTION 10

EXPLOITATION

Bypass with an img tag — alternative payload

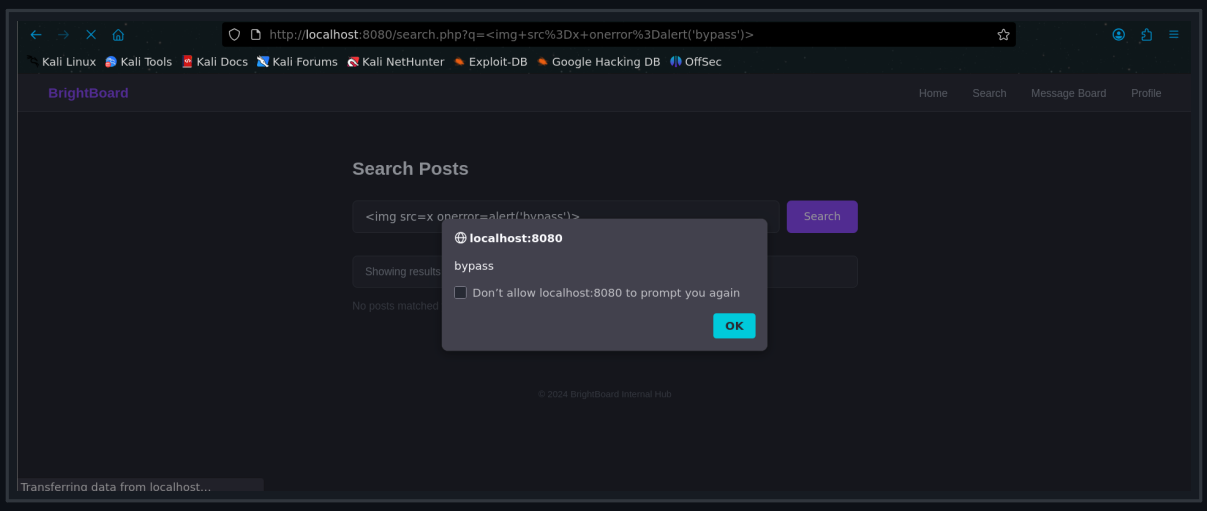
QUESTION

Type `<img src=x onerror=alert('bypass')>` in the search box and click Search. The browser tries to load an image from x, fails, and the onerror part fires — running the JavaScript. What word appears in the alert?

HOW TO SOLVE

1. In the search box, type exactly: <img src=x onerror=alert('bypass')>
2. Click Search.
3. The browser attempts to load an image from the source x — which does not exist.
4. When the image fails to load, the onerror event fires and runs the JavaScript.
5. Read the word shown in the alert — this confirms <script> is not the only injection method.

SCREENSHOTS



ANSWER **bypass**